Year 5 English | The Final Decision

Learn and notice | Link motivation, choice and consequence

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Name: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention

I can show what a character wants and connect their final decision to a meaningful consequence.

Model scene: The Empty Seat

Arun reached the final empty seat on the bus. He had been looking forward to sitting beside his friend and showing him a new comic. Then he noticed a passenger steadying a large shopping bag while holding the rail.

Arun kept one hand on the seat. His friend tapped the comic impatiently. The bus began to move, and the passenger's bag slipped against their leg. Arun looked from the comic to the crowded aisle.

He lifted his bag from the seat and offered it to the passenger. Afterwards, he stood where he could hold a rail safely. His friend closed the comic and made room beside him. They could talk now and read it when they arrived.

Writing detective

1. What does Arun want at the beginning?
2. Which detail makes his choice difficult?
3. How does the ending show a consequence of his decision?

Notice and explain

A. Arun decided to help. Everything was perfect.
B. Arun offered the seat and saved the comic for when they arrived.
Which gives a more specific consequence? Explain.

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Year 5 English | The Final Decision

Think and plan | Link motivation, choice and consequence

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Your writing task

Write The Final Decision for classmates. Give your character a goal, a difficult choice and an ending shaped by the decision. You may use a different setting from the model.

What the character wants

Choose a goal the reader can understand. Why does it matter?

Competing need or concern

What makes the choice difficult? Avoid making one option meaningless.

Actions before the decision

Show hesitation or weighing options through relevant behaviour.

Final decision

What does the character choose? Why does it fit or change their motivation?

Consequence and ending

What changes because of the choice? Show it rather than adding an unrelated lesson.

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Write your draft | Use your own ideas

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Your turn

Write The Final Decision for classmates. Give your character a goal, a difficult choice and an ending shaped by the decision. You may use a different setting from the model.
Useful words: hesitated, offered, postponed, considered, consequence. Use words only when they fit.

My writing

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Edit and improve | Show what changed

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Read your draft aloud

[ ] The character has a clear motivation.
[ ] The decision involves a meaningful choice.
[ ] Actions reveal the character's thinking.
[ ] The ending shows a consequence of the choice.

One focused improvement

Before: She was kind and made a decision.
After: Leila placed her prize token in her brother's hand, although she had planned to use it herself.
Replace a general judgement with a choice or action. Make clear what the character gains or gives up.

My before-and-after revision

Original sentence(s):

Improved version:

Explain your change

My change helps the reader because _____

Final writing detective check

[ ] I checked capitals, punctuation and spelling.
[ ] I grouped related ideas in paragraphs where useful.
[ ] I can explain one meaningful change.

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Teacher and parent guide | Answers and teaching support

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Teaching sequence

Use two sessions: read/discuss/plan (about 20–25 minutes), then write/revise (about 20–30 minutes). Adjust to the learner. Rehearse orally before writing; supply extra paper if needed. Models are teaching examples, not scripts to memorise.

Answers and acceptable alternatives

Arun wants to sit with his friend and share the comic. He must choose between that wish and helping a passenger with a heavy bag. He offers the seat, postpones reading and finds a way to stay connected with his friend. Other supported explanations are acceptable.
Notice task: B shows the cost and practical effect of the choice. A is a broad judgement without a concrete consequence.

Support, challenge and coaching

Support: Rehearse two realistic choices and their consequences. Use a small everyday dilemma.
Challenge: Let the character's priorities change during the story. Show the change without explaining a moral at length.
Ask: What does the character give up or gain? How do we see that in the ending?

Record learning and check transfer

For each page 4 skill, record Not yet / With support / Independently. Give one specific next step and let the child make the change. Record adult prompting or scribing.
Later prompt: The Shared Prize. Hide the model and check whether the target skill transfers. These are classroom practice criteria, not NAPLAN scores.

Curriculum and preparation scope

Supports selected aspects of AC9E5LY06: developing ideas, organising and linking paragraphs, precise vocabulary and text connectives. Guided skill practice for NAPLAN preparation; not an official test or score prediction.
Sources: ACARA v9 Year 5 "Informative text: Bushfires"; nap.edu.au narrative and persuasive writing guides.

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